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The economy of Hausa communities of Zaria

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Avoidance-shame relationships among kin, as distinct from affines, hold between either parent and their individual dan fari or first-born. This is a reciprocal relationship which sometimes gives rise to the adoption of the dan fari by his kawu (mother's brother), baba (father's brother) or his paternal or maternal grandparents. It involves a mutual name-taboo. With the exception of the younger siblings and cross-cousins of a spouse of either sex, avoidance relations hold between a person and his relatives by marriage, and this is extended to include the parents and elder siblings of the couple reciprocally, e.g. the husband's parents and the wife's parents hold a respect relation with one another. In affinal relations of this type, avoidance is practised where there is a generation difference between the parties involved, and respect is required between members of the same generation, e.g. between the husband's parents and the wife's parents. Ideally the avoidance-shame relation based on affinity should extend to the classificatory kin of the spouses. The 'cride and the bridegroom are expected to display an avoidance-shame relationship to one another in public, particularly on the occasion of a first marriage.

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Fondness relationships hold between Ego and his or her father's sister (gogo) and between Ego and his or her mother's brother (kawu). The children of Ego's gogo and kawu are Ego's joking relations (abokan wasa) and preferred spouses in the marriage known as auren zumunta (see p. 49). The fondness relationships between Ego and his gogo or kawu are not completely reciprocal, as gogo or kawu may exercise disciplinary rights over the child. These relations of zumunta (fondness) are generalised to include distant relatives of the first ascendant generation occupying similar kinship relations to Ego who are described as kawu and gogo in the classificatory terminology,

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but in practice the effective gogo and kawu are the true siblings (yan uwa sosai) of Ego's parents. The fondness relations between Ego and his gogo and kawu are based on and repeat, for Ego, the fondness relations holding between the elder sister (ya) and her younger brother (kane), in this case Ego's father's sister, on the one hand, and his mother's brother (kawu) on the other. This relation of ya and kane discussed below is one of protection and fondness, and is paralleled, to a less striking degree, by a similar relation holding between a man and his full younger sister. (The wa and his kanwa). A fondness relationship also holds between a parent and his or her last child, who is known as auta. Parents are expected to show affection for their auta publicly, whereas they may not do so for their earlier children, and must practise avoidance and shame towards their first child (dan fari).

Joking relationships hold between cross-cousins on the father's or mother's side; between grandparents and grandchildren and, among affines, between the husband and his wife's younger sister, whom he calls "mata" (wife) as well as between a wife and her husband's younger brother, who also use the [unavailable] denoting husband and wife. Spouses also joke with one another's joking relations by blood. It is to be noted that joking relationships are not [unavailable] to kin and affines, but also hold on set occasions between categories or persons of different occupation, affiliation with an ethnic group, or state, thus: butchers and blacksmiths (mahauta, makira), mallams and hunters [unavailable], maharba, barber-doctors and blacksmiths (wanzamai, makira); [unavailable] and Fulani, men of Zaria and Kano, men of Zamfara and Katsina, and others. Joking relationships also hold between ethnic groups and occupational groups, such as Buzaye (serfs of the Asben people, Tuareg) and blacksmiths. Finally, joking relationships in limited contexts were observed between the family of a slave-owner and their slaves or serfs.

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There is reciprocal name-avoidance between parents and their first-born [unavailable], and between husband and wife. Non-reciprocal name avoidances are [unavailable] by children (except auta) towards parents, real or classificatory, and by children to ancestors of the 3rd ascending generation, real or classificatory and to other alternate ascending generations. Among affines (surukai) non-reciprocal name avoidance is observed by a man to his wife's parents, real or classificatory, and to her elder siblings, real or classificatory, and similarly by a wife to her husband's parents and elder siblings. non-reciprocal name avoidance, according to the ideal pattern, should hold between a pupil and his Koranic teacher. These norms are generally observed. [unavailable]-avoidance even when talking to a third party is required from children ■ 44 when speaking of their parents, more particularly their real parents, by parents of their dan fari (firstborn), by wives of husbands, and spouses of one another's real parents and elder siblings. An adopted or foster-child or the child of a woman by a former marriage in her later husband's home, will address its foster-father as Baba and avoid the use of his name; similarly a child addresses its foster-mother as Inna or Iya and avoids use of her name.

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